The Well-Tempered clAIvier

Fugue VIII in E-flat minor, nine voices

Nine keyboards (open score)

Claude / Sam (subject head after J. S. Bach, BWV 853)

Andante, sempre legato (♩ = 80)

Soprano I
Soprano II
Alto I
Alto II
Tenor I
Tenor II
Baritone
Bass I
Bass II

S rectus (head = BWV 853)
A answer
S rectus
A answer
S rectus
I5 inversus (at the 5th)

8

I inversus
A answer
retort (tail) in a-flat
retort in G-flat
retort in D-flat
S rectus (ninth voice)

S1
S2
A1
A2
T1
T2
Bar
B1
B2

16

SM rectus, G-flat major
IM inversus, G-flat major (stretto 3 beats)
SM rectus, D-flat major (answer)
I5 inversus (b-flat), off the beat
S augmentation x2 (b-flat)
S diminution (e-flat)
S diminution (b-flat)

23

S1
S2
A1
A2
T1
T2
Bar
B1
B2

S diminution (a-flat)
I diminution (a-flat), the dance turns over
I5 inversus (a-flat)
S augmentation x2 (a-flat), inner voice
SM rectus, C-flat major, off the beat (its last note anticipates the a-flat cadence)
SM rectus, G-flat major, off the beat
I5 inversus (e-flat), off the beat
I augmentation x2 (e-flat), bass

31

S1
S2
A1
A2
T1
T2
Bar
B1
B2

head on the dominant
I inversus
head inversus
S rectus
head (a-flat)
I inversus
head
S rectus
head inversus (a-flat)
S rectus (its final E-flat swallowed by the dominant)
S rectus on B-flat (real answer form)
head inversus
I5 inversus
head (a-flat)
I5 inversus, augmentation x2
head
SM rectus, G-flat major, augmentation x2
S quarter speed (x4) the arrival bass

41

S1
S2
A1
A2
T1
T2
Bar
B1
B2

S rectus on B-flat: the peak G-flat6 at b41.3
head
S augmentation x2 over Bach (3 beats later)
S rectus on B-flat
SM rectus, C-flat major, pp (three voices)
head inversus
BWV 853's own subject (J. S. Bach, WTC I/8), the guest
head
RI retrograde inversion x2 (the Prelude melody) in the bass